



Heuristic Evaluation / Competitive Analysis

– Berkshire Hathaway Claim Submission –

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What is a Heuristic Evaluation?

A heuristic evaluation is an approach to identify usability problems by comparing interfaces against accepted usability principles.

The Heuristics.

1. **Know thy user...and you are not she**

Understand our users...their business goals, needs, and processes.

2. **Define the informational hierarchy**

Organize the data effectively to help users find and use it.

3. **Use progressive disclosure**

Only display pertinent data and provide additional detail upon user request.

4. **Keep it simple**

Eliminate anything that diminishes the visibility of the pertinent data.

5. **Take advantage of perceived affordances**

An element's behavior is known based on appearance (ie. buttons look like buttons, links look like links).

6. **Things that look the same, act the same...things that look different, act different**

Be consistent. Visual consistency helps highlight data in a clear and concise manner.

7. **Provide appropriate feedback**

The interface should always inform users of what's happening.

8. **Minimize cognitive load**

Eliminate things that don't help users understand the data. Don't make them think...or ask them to remember.

9. **User control and freedom**

Support undo and redo. Allow users to leave unwanted states with a clearly marked "emergency exit".

10. **Provide context sensitive help**

Help should be easy to find...while listing concrete steps to precisely carry out tasks and avoid errors.

11. **Nurture trust and credibility**

Workflows should not be impeded by questioning the accuracy of the data.

12. **Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors**

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

Severity.



Critical

an adjustment is imperative to fix prior to release



Serious

an adjustment is essential and should be given high priority



Important

does not function as expected; an adjustment is recommended



Minor

cosmetic or irritating – slows the user down; an adjustment is advisable



No Issues

May be considered for future enhancement

1. Know thy user... and you are not she

BH does not have a true online claims submission. Users fill out a form to find the appropriate PDFs to download, then the user must upload the PDF back into their system.

Problem(s):

This is not a true online experience. It seems extra/unnecessary steps were built around a PDF form.

Baggage Claim Form

Instructions & Required Documentation

Please complete and sign the attached claim form. Additionally, the outlined items below are required in order to process your **baggage claim**. This form can be used to file claims for: items lost, stolen or damaged during your trip, or essential items purchased when your baggage was delayed or misrouted by a Common Carrier. Incomplete forms or documentation may delay claim processing.



Berkshire Hathaway
Travel Protection

Three Easy Ways to Submit Your Claim

You can submit your claim in one of these three easy ways:

- 1  **Scan/Upload** @ www.bhtp.com
- 2  **E-mail to:** claims@bhtp.com
- 3  **Mail to:** Berkshire Hathaway Specialty Concierge LLC
1145 Clark Street, Stevens Point, WI 54481

Questions?

Feel free to contact us.



Call: 855-487-1745



Fax: 715-303-6328



Tweet: @bhtpassist

Severity: ■■■■■

Recommendations:

- Build a true online claims submission... no downloading forms

2. Define the informational hierarchy

Nice styling/design of the wizard shows progress and what steps remain.

Problem(s):

None.



844-411-BHTP

SIGN IN

Destination
United States of America

Edit

Residence
Indianapolis, IN

Edit

Travel Modes
Flight

Edit

Dates

Travelers & Trip Cost

When are you traveling?

Select your Departure Date

November, 2016

SU	MO	TU	WE	TH	FR	SA
30	31	1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	1	2	3

Just a one-day trip? You still need to select a return date. Just hit the same date twice – once for departure and once for return.

PREVIOUS

NEXT

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Severity: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Recommendations:

- Break out the collection of data into easy, digestible chunks so users know where they are and how to go back

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3. Use progressive disclosure

Only after a Claim Type is selected do the Group and Travelers fields display. At first glance the form looks simple and easy to complete, but dynamically asks for the details needed.

Problem(s):

None.

ExactCare Family: Policy #200085980 (ACTIVE) - View Blocked Providers

Claim Type ?
Trip Cancellation

Country of Loss
Choose Country

Group
Choose a Group

State/Province of Loss
Choose State or Province

City of Loss
City

Cause
Choose a Cause

Date of Loss
/ /

Is this trip a cruise?
☐ Yes ☐ No

Select Affected Travelers
☒ Jarrod Murray

Severity: ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Recommendations:

- Make the claims entry screens as easy as possible by using progressive disclosure where feasible

4. Keep it simple

The design of this section is very simple...it lays out very clearly what the user needs to provide. Real-time feedback makes it easy to know what's next. Where this workflow breaks down is requiring users to download the Baggage Claim Form PDF, fill it out, and upload the completed form.

Problem(s):

The user has already jumped through some hoops, only to be handed a PDF they could have grabbed from the website.

Action Items ?

! This claim form is required to begin the claims process. Please download and complete the form.

⬇ Baggage Claim Form ⬆ Upload Completed Form

Required Documents 4

- 1 Claim Form ⬆
- 1 Other Proof of Loss ⬆
- 1 Proof of Travel ⬆
- 1 Receipts ⬆

Optional Documents

- ✓ Verification of Age of Insured ⬆

Severity: ■■■■

Recommendations:

- Users should always know what's next...and what's needed from them

5. Take advantage of perceived affordances

Most elements behave as expected... buttons are clearly buttons, the chevrons open and close as expected.

Problem(s):

The policy dropdown is styled like a button instead of a dropdown. Users don't know what to expect when clicking on it.



CHOOSE YOUR COVERAGE ▾ AGENTS PARTNER PROGRAMS MORE ▾

EXACTCARE FAMILY: POLICY #200085980 (UPCOMING) ▾

CANCEL POLICY EDIT

View Documents

Product	Departure Date	Effective Dates
ExactCare Family	11/14/2016 EST	11/10/2016 - 11/17/2016
Policy Holder	Return Dates	Payment Method
Jarrold Murray	11/18/2016 EST	Credit Card
Destination	Purchased Date	Price
United States of America	11/09/2016	\$36.50
Residency	Trip Cost	
IN	\$280.00	

Policy Coverages *

▶ Baggage Delay

\$200

▶ Baggage/Effects

\$750

▶ Medical Expense

\$15,000

▶ Trip Cancellation

100% of \$280

▶ Trip Delay

\$500 (\$100/day)

▶ Trip Interruption

100% of \$280

▶ AD/D (Common-Carrier Air)

\$25,000

▶ Emergency Evac/Remains Repat

\$150,000

▶ Trip Interrupt (Return Air)

\$500

▼ Travelers

Jarrold Murray04/21/1978

* Want complete coverage details? Please refer to your policy.

Severity: ■■■■■

Recommendations:

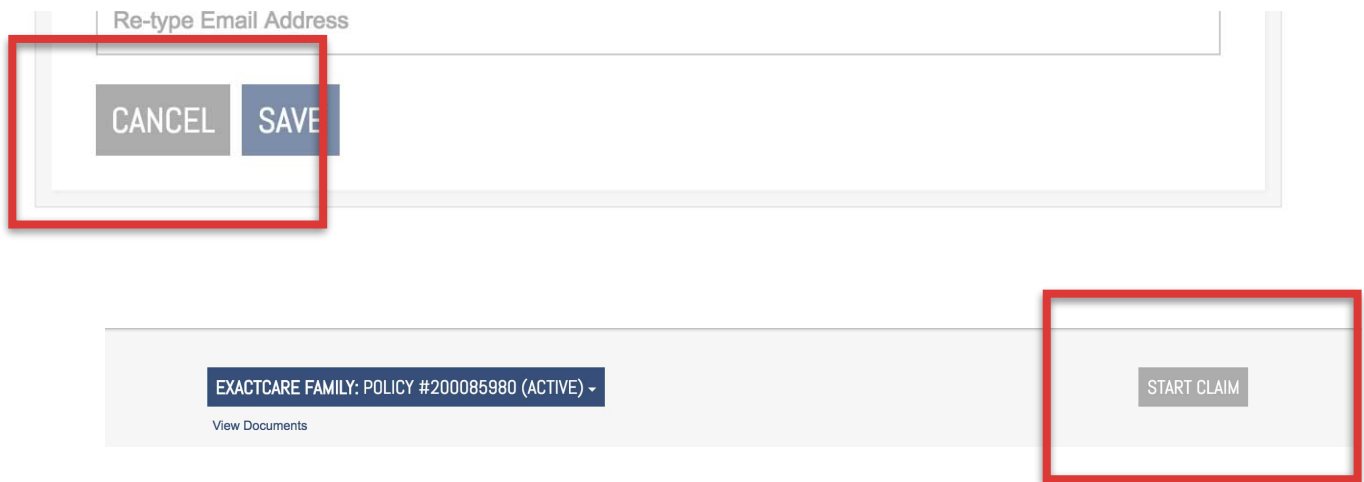
- Don't make users think. Style every element appropriately

6. Things that look the same, act the same... things that look different, act different

Below, the “Cancel” button is disabled, but the “Start Claim” button is active. Both buttons are using the exact same hex code (#ababab) which leads to confusion.

Problem(s):

Giving the appearance that “Start Claim” is disabled...when it is not... gives the user the feeling you don’t want them to file a claim. It’s poor customer service.



Severity:

Recommendations:

- Make the experience personable... don’t hinder the user by styling buttons to discourage action
- Don’t box ourselves in by using a small color palette

7. Provide appropriate feedback

BH does a good job of displaying feedback to help the user progress through the form. But by requiring users to download a PDF form they lose the ability to hold the user's hand throughout the process.

Problem(s):

BH does the majority of data collection in a PDF, where validation and feedback are very limited.

The screenshot shows a web form for 'ExactCare Family: Policy #200085980 (ACTIVE)'. A red rectangular box highlights two fields: 'Claim Type' and 'Country of Loss'. The 'Claim Type' field has a dropdown menu with 'Choose a Claim Type' and a red error message 'Claim Type is required.' below it. The 'Country of Loss' field has a dropdown menu with 'Choose Country' and a red error message 'Country is required.' below it. Below the highlighted fields, there are three more fields: 'Cause' (dropdown with 'Choose a Cause'), 'State/Province of Loss' (dropdown with 'Choose State or Province'), and 'City of Loss' (text input with 'City').

Severity:

Recommendations:

- Keep the workflows inside the app, where we can control the feedback... creating a better user experience

8. Minimize cognitive load

An extra burden is placed on the users in BH's workflow. Users are asked to download a file, fill it out, and upload the completed form.

Problem(s):

Instead of collecting data in the app, users are asked to complete extra steps. Coupled with the poor styling of the "Start Claim" button, it's starting to feel like BH doesn't have my best interests in mind.

Action Items ?

! This claim form is required to begin the claims process. Please download and complete the form.

⬇ Baggage Claim Form ⬆ Upload Completed Form

Required Documents 4

- 1 Claim Form ⬆
- 1 Other Proof of Loss ⬆
- 1 Proof of Travel ⬆
- 1 Receipts ⬆

Optional Documents

- ✓ Verification of Age of Insured ⬆

Severity: ■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Recommendations:

- Customers come first... collect their information in the app
- Do the right thing... collect their information in the app
- Own the solution...collect their information in the app
- Be precise... collect their information in the app

9. User control and freedom

Outside of the claims process...BH does an excellent job of allowing users to explore.

Problem(s):

None.



844-411-BHTP

SIGN IN

Destination

United States of America

Edit

Residence

Indianapolis, IN

Edit

Travel Modes

Flight

Edit

Dates

Depart: 11/14/2016

Return: 11/18/2016

Initial Payment: 11/09/2016

Edit

Travelers & Trip Cost

Enter Traveler Details

Your total trip cost is the sum of trip-related, non-refundable expenses that you would be likely to book in advance and/or put a deposit on. It includes train, bus, rental car, etc.

Severity: ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Recommendations:

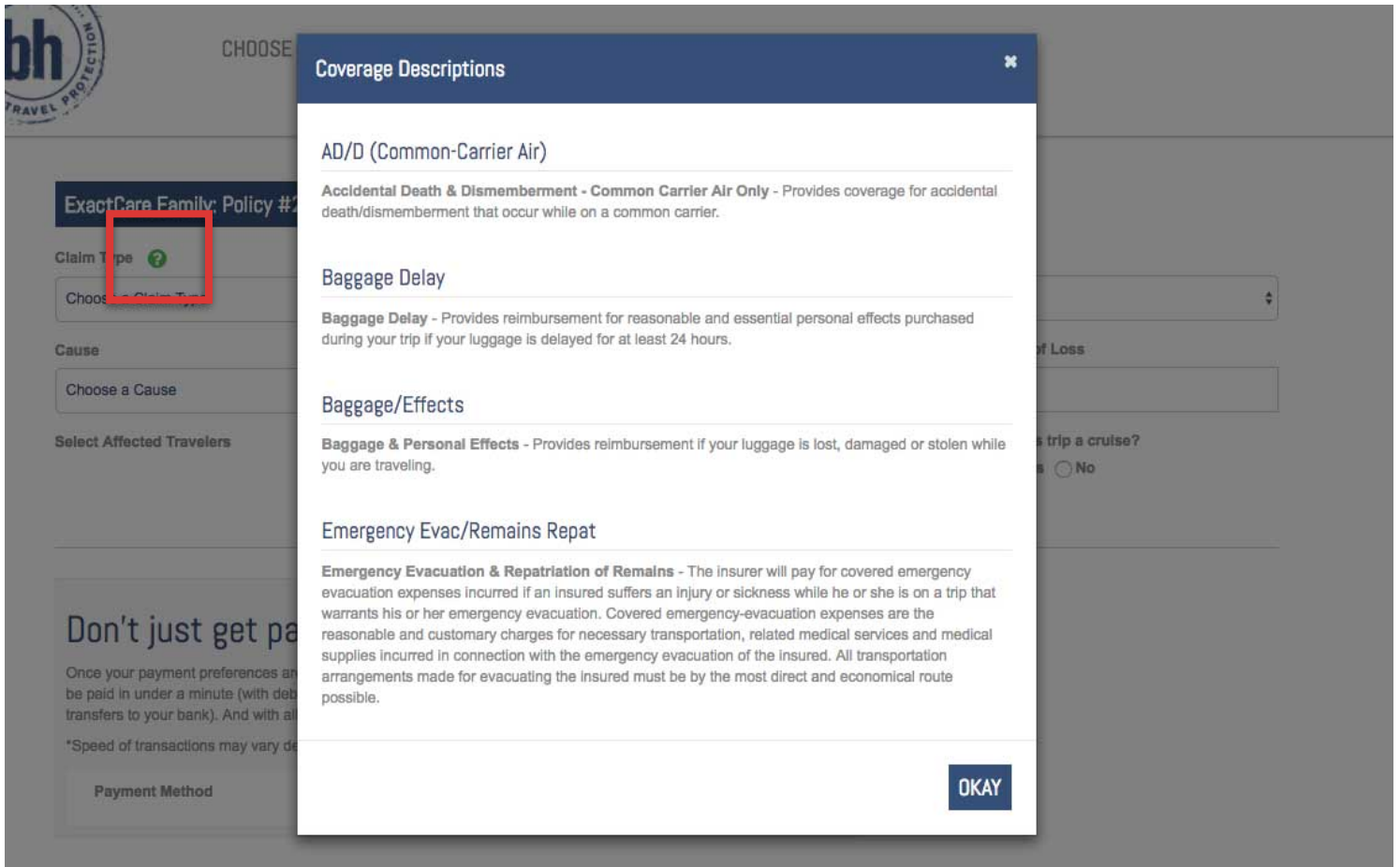
- Give this kind of freedom inside the claims process

10. Provide context sensitive help

BH uses a “?” icon next to items that may need further explanation. It’s an excellent use of progressive disclosure and context sensitive help.

Problem(s):

None.



Severity: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Recommendations:

- Provide just enough detail to help the user, but an easy way to get more details if needed

11. Nurture trust and credibility

BH does a lot of small things that don't build trust... like the styling of the "Start Claim" button, making users download forms, etc. Another example is the "Fraud Warning" language located next to the "Create a Claim" button. As a user, I know I haven't entered enough information at this point to create a claim... the Fraud Warning placement acts as a deterrent.

Problem(s):

I trust the data on the screen... but at this point I don't feel like BH is helping me.

ExactCare Family: Policy #200085980 (ACTIVE) ▾

View Blocked Providers

Claim Type ?

Trip Cancellation ▾

Group

Other Event ▾

Cause ?

Other Event ▾

Country of Loss

United States of America ▾

State/Province of Loss

Indiana ▾

City of Loss

Indianapolis ▾

Date of Loss

11/11/2016 

Is this trip a cruise?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Select Affected Travelers

☒ Jarrod Murray

Don't just get paid ... get reimBURST.

EDIT

Once your payment preferences are saved, any approved BHTP claim payments are sent there automatically. You can be paid in under a minute (with debit-card payments), a matter of minutes (with PayPal), or in about a day (with EFT transfers to your bank). And with all these methods, there's never a risk of a claim check vanishing from your mailbox.

*Speed of transactions may vary depending on receiving financial institution.

Payment Method

None Selected

☐ I have read and understand the Fraud Warning.

CREATE A CLAIM

Severity: ■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Recommendations:

- People file claims when something negative has happened... be a partner not a hinderance through the claims process

12. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

Errors are very clearly marked and easy to overcome.

Problem(s):

Again... by moving some of the workflow outside the app, you limit your ability to reduce errors.

The screenshot shows a web form for submitting a claim. At the top, there is a header bar with the text "ExactCare Family: Policy #200085980 (ACTIVE)" and a link "View Blocked Providers". Below this, the form is divided into several sections. The "Claim Type" section is highlighted with a red box. It contains a dropdown menu labeled "Choose a Claim Type" with a question mark icon. Below the dropdown, there is a red error message: "Claim Type is required." Below this, there is a "Cause" section with a dropdown menu labeled "Choose a Cause". To the right of the "Claim Type" section, there are fields for "Country of Loss" (dropdown), "State/Province of Loss" (dropdown), "City of Loss" (text input), "Date of Loss" (calendar icon), and "Is this trip a cruise?" (radio buttons for Yes/No). At the bottom, there is a "Select Affected Travelers" section.

Severity:

Recommendations:

- Don't allow errors to occur outside of the app

Summary

Berkshire Hathaway makes online claims submission more difficult than it should be. The customer experience is poor from start to finish. BH sells customers on the ease of reimbursement rather than the ease of submitting the claim. After jumping through multiple hoops, the customer has earned that refund.

Things to emulate:

- The simplicity of the “Required Documents” section... it’s very clear what the user needs to provide

Things to avoid:

- Things that hinder the user from submitting the document
 - Deception... like styling buttons to look disabled
 - Scare tactics... placing fraud warnings next to incorrectly labeled buttons
 - Cognitive load... a workflow requiring downloading AND uploading